



Hispanic Outreach & Latinx Awareness

Organization Constitution

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Article I Name

The name of this club shall be the “Hispanic Outreach & Latinx Awareness” Student Organization (HOLA)

Article II Mission Statement

HOLA presents its mission to provide engaged learning experiences and exposure to both the Hispanic and Latinx cultures on campus. As a community, we will strive towards success by promoting self-awareness and acceptance. It is important for us to share the Hispanic and Latinx culture with our Furman community and at large, so we can strengthen our relationships by inviting students to learn about the different backgrounds that make up Furman University. Through local community networking and on-campus collaboration with other organizations, we will create an open and safe environment to engage students with the Hispanic and Latinx communities.

Article III Purpose

The purpose of HOLA shall be to foster leadership development through the coordination of educational and awareness projects that allow all students and faculty to learn about the different Hispanic and Latinx backgrounds through:

- a. Coordinating regular series of open discussions among all club members.
- b. Meet with Student Involvement, Student Diversity Council, and Furman Admissions to provide input and feedback on current service projects.
- c. Creating Cultural Learning Programs (CLPs) that focus on topics relevant to the current time or related to the Hispanic and Latinx community.
- d. Organizing interactive and engaging programs or subcommittees with the organization to foster the interest of club members and the Furman community.
- e. Manage Fiesta Hispana and coordinate several programs and functions during Hispanic Heritage Month.
- f. Creating community outreach and engagement with outside organizations within the Greenville community.

Article VI Membership

Section 3.1 Membership in HOLA shall be open to any interested Furman University Student.

Section 3.2 Furman University Alumni may join the club as “Associate members”. Associate members may not run for office and do not have voting rights. Associate members may participate in any service project and activity. The role of an Associate member is to offer guidance and support to all club members and officers.

Section 3.3 To be considered an active member of HOLA all student members must miss no more than 25% of all club meetings per semester. Any absences must be reported to the club secretary as soon as possible. Members who do not report absences or miss more than 25% per semester may be placed on probation and/or dismissed from active membership status.

Section 3.4 In addition, to maintain active membership status, every member should complete the club minimum requirement of service participating or helping organizing club events and programs.

Section 3.5 All members must follow club rules and expectations of the HOLA club constitution ‘membership requirements’ and the club expectations.

Section 3.6 If deemed necessary, a person’s membership may be reviewed by the club advisor, Associate members, and officers for any repeated or serious violation of the club constitution. Members may also be expelled by a unanimous vote of the club advisor(s), Associate members, and officers for any inappropriate behavior.

Article V Officers

Section 5.1 The club officers of HOLA shall be the President, Vice President, Secretary, Chief of staff, Treasurer, and SDC Representative. The creation of additional officer positions must be approved by a two-thirds vote of the active members and with the support of the advisor and associate members.

Section 5.2 Only Furman University Undergraduate Students shall run for executive officer positions.

Section 5.3 The duties of the President shall include:

- a. Providing leadership for the club
- b. Coordinating bi-weekly meetings
- c. Coordinating Service Projects
- d. Chairing all meetings of the club and holding monthly meetings with all committees.
- e. Participating in all programs and projects.
- f. Creating agendas that must be abided by all executive members.
- g. Evaluating and monitoring club performance and impact.
- h. Responsible for officer training.
- i. Running organization elections pursuant to Article VI
- j. Calling emergency meetings, pursuant to Article X. Section 3
- k. Working directly with the advisor(s) to ensure the club is operating within the expectations of the Furman Universities Student Diversity Council.
- l. Acting as the chief spokesperson of the club
- m. Establishing effective relationships with the school's Administration and other leaders of the different school organizations as well as with outside community organizations.
- n. Work with the advisor(s) and treasurer to establish an annual budget and the distribution of funds

Section 5.4 The duties of the Vice President shall include:

- a. Assisting the President with the fulfillment of his/her duties
- b. Serve as the Student Diversity Council Representative for the club and assume all duties pursuant to the SDC constitution.
- c. Appointing all committee chairs, pursuant to Article VII.
- d. Plan meetings for committees found within the club.
- e. Providing support for the development of club activities planned by the club committees.
- f. Create a report for President and advisor(s) pertaining to committee's progress or concerns which must be discussed in officer meetings.
- g. In the chance that the president cannot carry out his or her duties the vice president will assume to take charge of the president's duties.

Section 5.5 The duties of the Secretary shall include:

- a. Keeping detailed minutes of all meetings that shall be shared in a designated club folder within 24 hours after each club meeting.
- b. Keeping collective track of minutes from any club committee.
- c. Send out reminders for meetings, highlight partner organizations, and encourage member participation
- d. Circulate and distribute community information, event, activities, etc. through social media platforms, GroupMe, and emails.

- e. Establish clear lines of communication among all club leaders and club members
- f. Must also work alongside with president, vice president, and advisor(s)
- g. Keep a detailed folder or account of all club events, flyers, and distributed papers for the club.
- h. Assist the president in branding and creating flyers for events and programs.
- i. Coordinate the distribution of program and event flyers.
- j. Be the Chief editor and administrator of social media outlets.
- k. Work with SDC historian

Section 5.6 The Duties of the Chief of Staff

- a. **Strategic Planning:** Develop and execute long-term and short-term strategic plans to advance the organization's goals and mission.
- b. **Leadership Support:** Provide direct support to the organization's leadership, including the president, vice president, and other executive board members.
- c. **Member Engagement:** Foster a sense of community and engagement among organization members through events, workshops, and activities.
- d. **Records Management:** Maintain accurate records, documents, and archives related to the organization's activities, decisions, and achievements.
- e. **Sustainability and Succession Planning:** Work on strategies to ensure the organization's long-term sustainability and plan for a smooth transition of leadership.
- f. **Crisis Management:** Be prepared to handle unexpected challenges or crises that may arise and develop contingency plans.

Section 5.7 The duties of the Treasurer Shall include:

- a. Recording all bank statements and be responsible for keeping a record of all funds and expenditures of HOLA
- b. Keeps a folder of photocopies of all the receipts which should all be submitted to the treasurer
- c. within 24 hours after attaining receipts from transactions.
- d. Submit an oral report to the SDC of the state of treasury once a month.
- e. Prepare written financial reports for HOLA requests.
- f. Maintain communication with the president about expenditures.
- g. Approve and make card check requests.
- h. Approve and make card request.

Section 5.8 The Duties of an SDC Representative

- a. Attend SDC Representative meetings every Tuesday (or when planned) and share any group information with the rest of the SDC student organizations.
- b. Update the other officers about anything stated within the SDC representative meetings.
- c. **Advocacy and Representation:** Advocate for the interests and concerns of the organization's members within the larger student community or campus administration.
- d. **External Relations:** Represent the organization to external partners, stakeholders, and sponsors, maintaining positive relationships and seeking potential partnerships.
- e. **Leadership Support:** Provide direct support to the organization's leadership, including the president, vice president, and other executive board members.
- f. **Member Engagement:** Foster a sense of community and engagement among organization members through events, workshops, and activities.

- g. Team Coordination: Facilitate collaboration among different committees or teams within the organization to ensure cohesive efforts and achievement of objectives.

Section 5.9 Additional Requirements For all Organization Officers

- a. All officers will attend at least one of the Council of Club Leaders meeting each semester as part of their official officer responsibilities.

Article VI Officer Selection/Impeachment

Section 6.1 All club officers shall be selected by the end of April and will assume their leadership role immediately for the following year.

Section 6.2 Officers will be selected by the following a three-step process: 1. Application, 2. Election, 3. Run-off elections (if needed)

- a. Application - any current active club member is eligible to apply. Interested members must request and complete their candidacy application by the designated deadline before the election meeting.
 - 1. Members may be nominated by other club members.
- b. Elections – Elections will consist of each candidate speaking for up to two minutes, followed by up to three minutes of questions and answers from the club membership. Only active members present at the meeting shall cast a vote, and only these votes shall count towards the computation of the majority vote for election to office. The order of the elections shall be as follows.
President, Vice President, Secretary, and Treasurer.
 - 1. President elections will count differently. Only current officers and committee chairs can each receive a whole vote when voting for President. Club members vote will count as one whole vote towards the president’s election.
- c. Run-off Election – if no candidate receives a majority of the votes of the currently active members, a run-off shall be held between the two candidates who receive the most votes.
 - 1. If the tie continues, current officers vote and the organizations advisor(s) will collectively break the tie.

Section 6.3 In the event that an officer is judged to be deficient in his/her duties (as decided by a unanimous agreement of the two other club officers and advisor), he/she may be removed by a two-thirds vote of the club's membership. The Advisor shall oversee the impeachment process to ensure a fair and democratic process. The filing of an office vacated by impeachment shall be conducted by a special election held in the manner of elections as defined in Article VI, Section 2. In the case of a vacancy for the President, the Vice President shall be the appointed President, and a replacement for the Vice President shall be elected.

Section 6.4 Probationary Period (Amended 2.4.19)

An officer who does has been deemed to be unfit by majority vote of officers in the executive board due to not meeting officer expectations or has missed more than the three absences as mention in the article of officer expectations will begin probationary period.

A probationary period will last no more than 7 days after deemed unfit to fulfill their duties as an HOLA officer. During this period members must find ways as to address the issue to the executive board. After

completing the probationary period, officers must submit a personal appeal letter to be reconsidered for their position.

Within 24 hours of submitted the appeal letter, the officer may only obtain their position by majority vote.

If officer is deemed for impeachment the executive board must proceed with protocol for impeachment pursuant to the HOLA Constitution

An officer will only be permitted one probationary period as result of not meeting officer expectations and fulfilling their duties. If an officer fails to meet expectations after probationary period and appeal letter, they will be deemed for automatic impeachment

Article VII Committee Chair

Section 7.1 The club officers shall decide on an annual basis with the committees needed to be established in order to advance the club's position on campus.

Section 7.2 All committee chairs will be appointed no later than the end of the school year by the vice president. All appointments must be approved by a majority of the club officers. Presidents vote will ultimately be tie breaker, allowing him/her an extra delegation vote. If president refuses to be tie breaker than the club advisor(s) will be given a vote.

Section 7.3 Only students may serve as a committee chair

Section 7.4 The duties of all committee chairs shall include:

- a. Selecting members to serve in their respective committee.
- b. Coordinating and chairing committee meetings, as needed.
- c. Keeping the club officers and advisors aware of the plans and intentions of the committee all of which the president must approve.
- d. Becoming familiar with Furman University policies and procedures.
- e. Article VIII Advisor(s)

Section 8.1 The club officers shall unanimously agree upon and appoint the organizations advisor(s) by the end of April and will immediately assume their position for their whole two-year term.

Section 8.2 The Advisor(s) must be a full-time instructor of the Spanish Department of Modern Languages at Furman University and/or a HOLA Alumni who was once an elected officer during the time as a Furman Undergraduate Student.

Section 8.3 There shall be no more than two club advisors and one must be a full time Professor of the Spanish Department of Modern Languages at Furman University.

Section 8.4 The duties of the club Advisor(s) shall include:

- a. Meeting with the organizations President at least once a month.
- b. Attending at least one club meeting and 3 club activities per semester.
- c. Taking care of the HOLA budget with school's treasurer.
- d. Assisting with the implementation of an officer's transition.
- e. Apply for CLPs and be the moderator of them

Section 8.5 The advisor(s) shall not have a voting right only under circumstances pursuant to articles VI and VII.

Section 8.6 The advisor(s) shall only veto power over any decision made by the club that directly violates the school's policy. This authority shall be used only in circumstances where all the officers knowingly violate the school's policy.

Article VIII Advisor Expulsion:

Section 9.1 In the event that a club Advisor is judged to be deficient in his/her duties (as decided by a unanimous agreement of all club members including associate members, he/she may be removed by two-thirds vote of the club membership.

Section 9.2 The filing of an advisor vacated by expulsion shall follow the following procedures

- a. If there is a second advisor in the current position, he/she shall solely become the only advisor for the remainder of the term.
- b. If any Associate member is active in the club and interested, he/she shall be voted on unanimously by the whole membership vote of two-thirds.
- c. If there are no Associate members, the club shall temporarily continue as club officers choose a new club Advisor.
- d. Officers have 7 days to choose a new club Advisor.

Article IX Meetings

Section 10.1 The club shall meet twice a month, holding bi-weekly meetings. A listing of meeting dates shall be established by the club officers and shall be emailed to the members no less than one month before scheduling the meetings.

Section 10.2 Only active student members may vote at meetings. The quorum to conduct business or make major changes shall be 50% of active members.

Section 10.3 In the event that an emergency meeting of the club needs to be held, the President of the club shall have the authority to call such meetings. All officers must agree in advance to the emergency meeting and at least 48 hours' notice must be provided to all active members by sending out e-mails and all platforms of communication authorized by the secretary. Communication of emergency meetings will be the responsibility of the Secretary.

Appointed Senior Advisor(s) to the President

Section 11.1 The president shall be allowed to appoint no more than two senior advisors to assist in the functioning of the organization. They are not officer nor hold equivalent responsibilities to a club officer or advisor. Senior Advisors may attend officer meetings but have no voting rights on decisions needed.

Article X Amendments

Section 12.1 Amendments may be made to this constitution at any time by a two-thirds vote of the active club membership.

Section 12.2 Members interested in proposing amendments to the constitution must submit the proposed amendment to the president no later than seven days before the club's next meetings.

Section 12.3 The proposed amendment shall be presented via email to the active club members no later than five days prior to the meeting where the amendment will be debated.

Section 12.4 Upon receiving a two-thirds affirmative vote in favor of a constitutional amendment, the President shall submit the amendment in writing to the HOLA constitution followed by the signed signature of the club President and Advisor(s).

Article XI Relationship Between SDC and the Primary Advisor

Section 13.1 The HOLA Advisor(s) will work collaboratively with the SDC Advisor/Administrator to offer support and assistance to HOLA in the general operation of the organization, as well as provide any support needed from their perspective.

Article XII Affiliations

Section 14.1 There shall be no conjoined club affiliations with HOLA. This does not limit other clubs from cosponsoring events and programs with any other Furman University student organizations.

Officer Signatures

X Yoana Reyes-Zapata
President

X Tony Galdamez
Vice President

X Denisse Castro-Rivera
Secretary

X Mia Mantovani
Treasurer

X Vanessa Chavez
Chief of Staff

X Elda Yanira Enriquez
SDC Representative

Signature: Elda Yanira Enriquez
Elda Yanira Enriquez (Aug 9, 2023 14:43 EDT)

Email: enriel3@furman.edu

Signature: Mia Mantovani
Mia Mantovani (Aug 9, 2023 15:09 EDT)

Email: mantmi3@furman.edu

Signature: Yoana Reyes Zapata
Yoana Reyes Zapata (Aug 10, 2023 09:10 EDT)

Email: yoana.reyes-zapata@furman.edu

Signature: Tony Galdamez
Tony Galdamez (Aug 9, 2023 14:49 EDT)

Email: tony.galdamez@furman.edu

Signature: Vanessa Chavez
Vanessa Chavez (Aug 10, 2023 06:15 EDT)

Email: vanessa.chavez@furman.edu

Signature: Denisse Castro-Rivera
Denisse Castro-Rivera (Aug 10, 2023 15:46 EDT)

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